

MINUTES OF PTA MEETING

26TH AUGUST, 2013

IN ATTENDANCE:

PRESENT

Anjali Bhardwaj, Anju Dhar, Mayuri Garware, Renu Sakhrani, Revati Bhamare, Rita Jain, Saba Kapoor, Ritu Sangvi, Shalini Agarwal, Mona Chhabria, Vidhi Mehra, Karen Wichmann, Kiran Jindal, Esther Timmer, Mona Shah, Yamini Gawande, Meghana Baphna, Meetu Kunaber, Jyoti Korde, Anne Freeman, Deepthi Sasidharan, Odaliz Valentin, Eleonor Sarol Goransek, Vibha Malpani, Arundhati Mahadik, Albert Ferreira, Debbie Coomber, Jan Ali, Lakshmi Mahadevan, Michael Thompson.

ABSENT

Dimple Chedda, Regrets Divya Shah, Resigned Lalitha Mahesh, Resigned Nicola Pawar, Resigned Priya Mahendran, Rachna Takle, Resigned Anuradha Akunuri, Resigned Sharmila Mangwani, Resigned Megha Villait, Kisook Cho, Regrets Suchitra Iyer, Resigned Kim Mi Keong. Regrets

PRESIDENT'S UPDATE :

Renu convened the meeting stating that the PTA is a closed forum and sensitive issues are discussed here since there were many new parents that attended the meeting. She urged the new parents to join the PTA as it needed new energy and ideas. She clarified that two parents can also co-chair the post of class representative as it would make the task easier.

Being the first meeting in this academic year, everyone present introduced themselves.

Since there were several members absent, Renu deferred the elections of the office bearers to the next meeting.

TREASURER'S UPDATE :

Ritu updated us on the balance to a healthy Rs. 5,37,217.00.

DIRECTOR'S ADDRESS :

Mr. Thompson stated that he had been very confident in this years' DP results having a pass rate of 80%. It has exceeded his expectations by 3% and he gave the students full credit for it. He also said that there was a 5-6-7 points turnaround in some students.

The average grades of the DP results this year were 30 points and ten students had scored above it.

Mr. Thompson said that the school was very hopeful in the new faculty that was recruited this year. He is confident they will take the school to the next level.

He also said that there was a magazine called," Education World" that had ranked MBIS second in the International Schools in India. He said MBIS had nothing to do with that ranking as there was no interview of any kind with the school pertaining to it.

AGENDA ITEMS :

EMERGENCY SITUATIONS TURNAROUND TIME – PHONE TREE

Communication to parents incase of emergencies was discussed. Mr. Thompson said that unless the parents heard directly from the school, either ways, we were to continue with routine school activities. Ms. Coomber said "The My School" text to parents was a success, except for a few parents who did not receive this. The Phone Tree will be replaced with the above. Ms. Coomber has requested all parents to go on to "My School" and update their profiles to ensure no further glitches.

I.T. RESULTS

It was a general concern of a few parents who saw a huge drop in the grades of their children in the I.T. subject. 3 being the majority score (Ms. Coomber says that this statistic is not true). Ms. Coomber clarified asking them, not to go on past results as they were not accurate. It was mentioned that the earlier Academic year teacher had problems with his assessments and the tasks given to the students were not standardized as per the IB curriculum. It was a concern of the parents not being notified of the same since the teacher had been taking I.T. lessons for two years. Ms. Coomber reiterated stating that the situation had been rectified by recruiting a new teacher who will ensure that the students be given every opportunity to achieve their best.

REGISTRATION DAY CONFUSION

It was noted that the parents on Registration Day had a few problems going through the process. Ms. Coomber said the new programme “My School” is at its nascent stage and is bound to have a few teething problems. She asked for our patience and support. She also said the homework will be uploaded on “My School” by the end of the month. She would value inputs and suggestions from the parent. It was suggested to make the PYP and MYP Registration days different to avoid confusion. Mr. Thompson again asked for all parents to be present on Registration Day, as the school collected 90% of the information on that day.

REPORT CARD DELIVERY

It was requested by the parents to have the DP-2 Report Cards in advance a few days before school ending. Mr T said that thus would encourage students to leave early. Renu suggested that we have exceptions for students leaving MBIS and Mr T said they could do this.

COFFEE MORNING

The date for the Coffee Morning was decided for the 6th of September, 2013 at 10.30 am in the new walkway to the Hostel.

DATE OF DIWALI INTERNATIONAL DAY

The 24th of October, 2013, was decided as Diwali Day. Mr. Thompson said that this year is the 15th Anniversary of MBIS and 19th of December, 2013 was chosen as the date to celebrate it. He said that he would want minimum involvement of students and staff for the Diwali Day as they would be involved in the preparation for the Anniversary Day. Ms. Coomber said there will be a Talent Contest in the Secondary School a day before the 19th of December, 2013 and will also double up as a dress rehearsal for anniversary. Mr. Thompson said that there would be a proprietary visit in October and would start the preparations of the Anniversary Day soon after.

The meeting was adjourned at 4.10 pm.